

# 14 Path Integral

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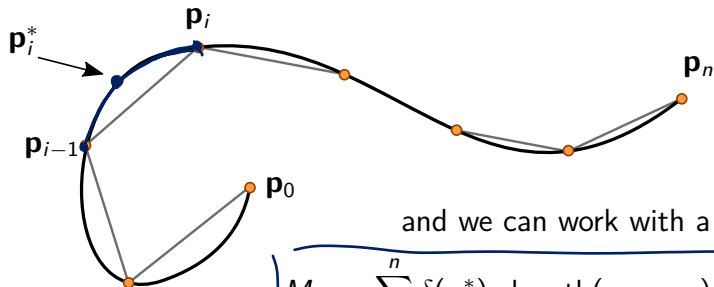
MATH2111 Several Variable Calculus, T1 2025

## Motivation

Suppose we'd like to evaluate the total mass of a weighted wire with known density  $\delta$ .

We can choose the points  $\mathbf{p}_0, \mathbf{p}_1, \dots, \mathbf{p}_n$  on the wire, splitting the wire into segments. The mass of each segment is approximately

$$m_i \approx \underbrace{\delta(\mathbf{p}_i^*)}_{\text{density}} \cdot \underbrace{\text{length}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{p}_{i-1})}_{\text{length of segment}},$$



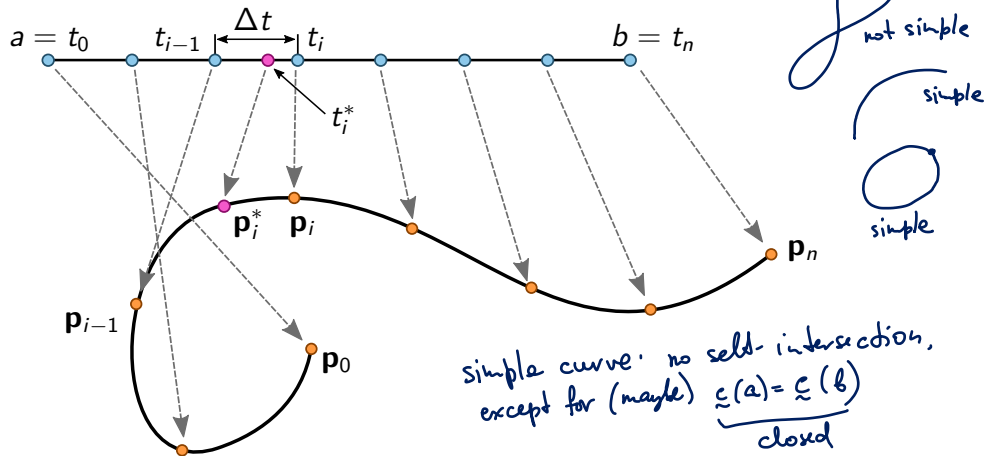
and we can work with a Riemann sum, for instance,

$$M_n := \sum_{i=1}^n \delta(\mathbf{p}_i^*) \cdot \text{length}(\mathbf{p}_i, \mathbf{p}_{i-1}),$$

to define a path integral.

## Integration over a path

Let  $f : \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  and  $\mathbf{c} : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$  be a simple path. We would like to work on the domain of the path instead of its image (trace).



## Integration over a path

### Definition 14.1 (Path Integral)

Let  $\mathbf{c} : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$  be a simple  $C^1$  path, and let  $f : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$  be such that the composite function  $t \mapsto f(\mathbf{c}(t))$  is continuous on  $[a, b]$ . Then the path integral of the function  $f$  over the curve  $C = \mathbf{c}([a, b])$  is

$$\int_C f \, ds = \int_a^b f(\mathbf{c}(t)) \|\mathbf{c}'(t)\| \, dt.$$

When  $f(\mathbf{x}) = 1$ , this integral gives a familiar expression for the length of a path/curve.

$$\int_a^b \|\mathbf{c}'(t)\| \, dt$$



### Example 14.2

Evaluate the integral

$$f(x, y, z) = xyz$$

$$\underline{c}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} t \\ \frac{1}{3}\sqrt{2}t^{3/2} \\ \frac{1}{2}t^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

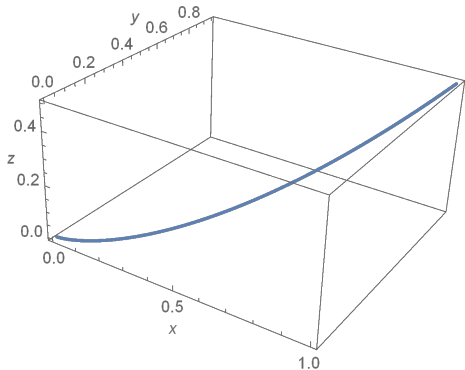
$$\int_C xyz \, ds,$$

where  $C$  is the curve defined as  $\underline{x}(t) = t$ ,  $\underline{y}(t) = \frac{1}{3}\sqrt{8}t^{3/2}$ ,  $\underline{z}(t) = \frac{1}{2}t^2$ ,  $0 \leq t \leq 1$ .

$$\int_C xyz \, ds = \int_0^1 \underline{f}(\underline{c}(t)) \cdot \|\underline{c}'(t)\| \, dt \quad \textcircled{=}$$

$$\underline{c}'(t) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ \sqrt{2}t^{1/2} \\ t \end{pmatrix} \quad \|\underline{c}'(t)\| = \sqrt{\underbrace{1 + 2t + t^2}_{(1+t)^2}} = (1+t)$$

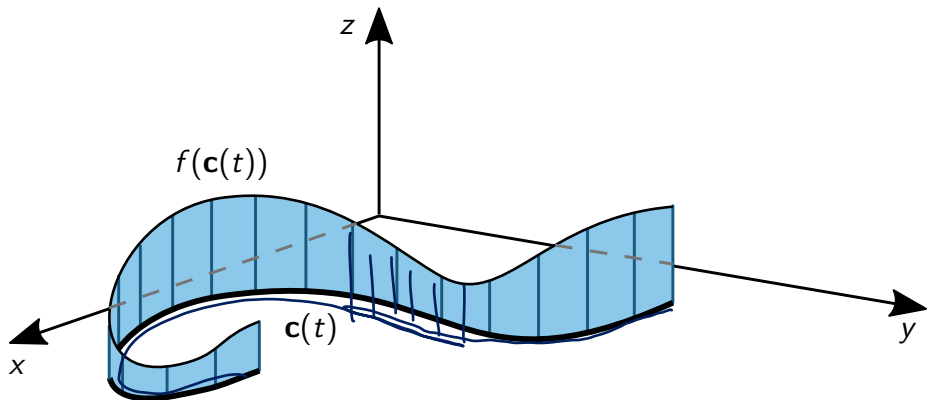
$$\underline{f}(\underline{c}(t)) = t \cdot \frac{1}{3}\sqrt{2}t^{3/2} \cdot \frac{1}{2}t^2 = \frac{\sqrt{2}}{3} t^{9/2}$$



$$\textcircled{=}\int_0^1 \frac{\sqrt{2}}{3} t^{1/2} (1+t) dt = \dots = \frac{16\sqrt{2}}{143}$$

## Why do we care that the curve is simple?

An alternative interpretation of the path integral is the area under the graph of a function defined on a curve. If the parametrisation is chosen incorrectly, for instance, two segments of a curve overlap, we may obtain an incorrect value when evaluating a path integral.



### Example 14.3 (Inappropriate parametrisation)

We evaluate the circumference of the unit circle using a path integral.

**Correct calculation:**

$$\mathbf{c}(t) = (\cos t, \sin t), \quad 0 \leq t \leq 2\pi,$$

$$\int_C 1 \, ds = \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{\sin^2 t + \cos^2 t} \, dt = \int_0^{2\pi} dt = 2\pi.$$

**Incorrect calculation:** choosing a parametrisation with an overlap,

$$\mathbf{c}(t) = (\cos t, \sin t), \quad 0 \leq t \leq \underline{\underline{3\pi}},$$



we obtain an absurd answer

$$\int_C 1 \, ds \quad \text{"="} \quad \int_0^{3\pi} \sqrt{\sin^2 t + \cos^2 t} \, dt = \int_0^{3\pi} dt = \underline{\underline{3\pi}}.$$

## Polar curves

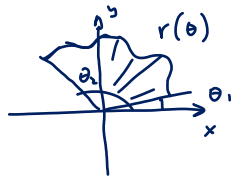
### Example 14.4

When the curve is described via its equation in polar coordinates as  $r = r(\theta)$ , show that the integral of a function  $f$  over this curve can be evaluated using the formula

$$\int_C \underbrace{f(x, y)} ds = \int_{\theta_1}^{\theta_2} \underbrace{f(r \cos \theta, r \sin \theta) \sqrt{r^2 + r'^2}} d\theta.$$

Note that for  $f(x, y) = 1$  we obtain an expression for the length of a curve in polar coordinates,

$$\int_C ds = \int_{\theta_1}^{\theta_2} \sqrt{r^2 + r'^2} d\theta.$$



$$r = r(\theta) \quad \underline{c}(\theta) = \begin{pmatrix} x \\ y \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} r(\theta) \cos \theta \\ r(\theta) \sin \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\underline{c}'(\theta) = \begin{pmatrix} -r(\theta) \sin \theta + r'(\theta) \cos \theta \\ r(\theta) \cos \theta + r'(\theta) \sin \theta \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\|\underline{c}'(\theta)\| = \sqrt{\left( \underline{r}(\theta) \sin \theta + r'(\theta) \cos \theta \right)^2 + \left( r(\theta) \cos \theta + r'(\theta) \sin \theta \right)^2}$$

$$= \sqrt{r^2(\theta) \sin^2 \theta - 2r r' \sin \theta \cos \theta + \underbrace{(r'(\theta))^2 \cos^2 \theta} + r^2(\theta) \cos^2 \theta + \cancel{2r r' \cos \theta \sin \theta} + \underbrace{(r'(\theta))^2 \sin^2 \theta}}$$

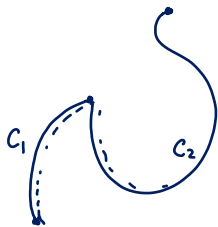
$$= \sqrt{r^2(\theta) + (r'(\theta))^2}$$

$$\int_{\theta_1}^{\theta_2} f(\underbrace{r \cos \theta}_{\uparrow r(\theta)}, \underbrace{r \sin \theta}_{\nearrow r(\theta)}) \sqrt{r^2 + (r')^2} d\theta$$

## Properties of the path integral

- $\int_C f_1 ds + \int_C f_2 ds = \int_C (f_1 + f_2) ds$  - given that  $\int_C f_1 ds$  &  $\int_C f_2 ds$  are well-defined
- $\int_C k f ds = k \int_C f ds$  for constant  $k \in \mathbb{R}$
- $\int_C f ds = \int_{C_1} f ds + \int_{C_2} f ds$ , where  $C$  consists of two non-overlapping segments  $C_1$  and  $C_2$ , sometimes written as  $C = C_1 + C_2$ .

Path integral doesn't depend on the orientation of the curve!



### Example 14.5 (Additivity)

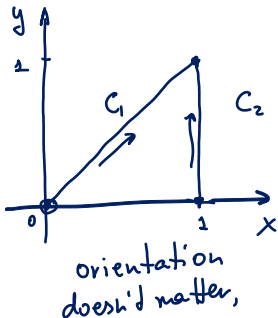
Let  $C$  be a piecewise linear curve that consists of two line segments: from  $(0,0)$  to  $(1,1)$  and from  $(1,1)$  to  $(1,0)$ . Evaluate

$$I = \int_C (x + y^2) ds.$$

$$C_1: \underline{c}_1(t) = \begin{pmatrix} t \\ t \end{pmatrix}, \quad t \in [0,1]$$

$$C_2: \underline{c}_2(t) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ t \end{pmatrix}, \quad t \in [0,1]$$

$$\begin{matrix} A, B \\ [(1-t)A + tB], t \in [0,1] \\ \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{pmatrix} + t \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} t \\ t \end{pmatrix} \end{matrix}$$



$$\|\underline{c}_1'(t)\| = \|(1,1)\| = \sqrt{2}, \quad \|\underline{c}_2'(t)\| = \|(0,1)\| = 1$$

$$I = I_1 + I_2, \quad I_1 = \int_{C_1} (x + y^2) ds, \quad I_2 = \int_{C_2} (x + y^2) ds$$



$$I_1 = \int_0^1 \underbrace{(t+t^2)}_{f(\underline{c}(t))} \cdot \underbrace{\sqrt{2}}_{\|\underline{c}'(t)\|} dt = \dots = \frac{5\sqrt{2}}{6}$$

$$I_2 = \int_0^1 (1+t^2) \cdot 1 dt = \dots = \frac{4}{3}$$

$$\therefore I = I_1 + I_2 = \frac{5\sqrt{2}}{6} + \frac{4}{3}$$

$$\boxed{\int_1^0 (1+t^2) \cdot 1 dt = -\frac{4}{3}}$$

$$\int_a^b f(\underline{c}(t)) \|\underline{c}'(t)\| dt$$

$a < b$

## Basic applications

- Mass of a wire:  $M = \int_C \delta(x, y) ds$ , here  $\delta(x, y)$  is the density.
- Centre of mass:  $\bar{x} = \frac{1}{M} \int_C x \delta(x, y) ds$ ,  $\bar{y} = \frac{1}{M} \int_C y \delta(x, y) ds$ .

*Analogous expressions for the three-dimensional case.*

### Example 14.6

A wire of density  $\delta(x, y, z) = 15\sqrt{y+2}$  lies along the curve  $C$  parametrised by

$$\mathbf{c}(t) = (t^2 - 1)\mathbf{j} + 2t\mathbf{k}, \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$

Find the centre of mass of this wire.

$$\mathbf{c}'(t) = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 2t \\ 2 \end{pmatrix} \quad \|\mathbf{c}'(t)\| = \sqrt{4t^2 + 4} = 2\sqrt{t^2 + 1}$$

$$M = \int_C \delta \, ds = \int_0^1 \delta(c(t)) \cdot \|c'(t)\| \, dt = \int_0^1 \underbrace{\sqrt{t^2 - 1 + 2}}_{\sqrt{t^2 + 1}} \cdot 2\sqrt{t^2 + 1} \, dt = \underline{40}$$

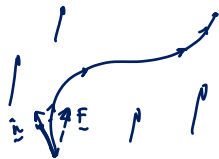
$$\bar{x} = 0, \quad \bar{y} = \frac{-24}{40}, \quad \bar{z} = \frac{45}{40}$$

## Vector path integrals

To calculate the work of a force field  $\mathbf{F}$  on an object that is moved along an oriented path  $C$  (defined by  $\mathbf{c} : [a, b] \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ ), we integrate the projection of this force onto the unit tangent vector of the curve:

$$\int_a^b \left( \underbrace{\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{c}(t))}_{\mathbf{F}(\mathbf{c}(t))} : \underbrace{\frac{\mathbf{c}'(t)}{\|\mathbf{c}'(t)\|}}_{\frac{\mathbf{c}'(t)}{\|\mathbf{c}'(t)\|}} \right) \|\mathbf{c}'(t)\| dt = \boxed{\int_a^b \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{c}(t)) \cdot \mathbf{c}'(t) dt.}$$


This is called the vector path integral of  $\mathbf{F}$  over an oriented curve  $C$  and is denoted by



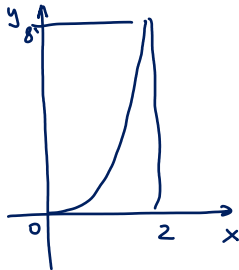
$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \int_a^b \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{c}(t)) \cdot \mathbf{c}'(t) dt.$$

Different parametrisations of the same oriented curve give the same value of this integral, however changing the orientation of the curve changes the sign of the integral.

### Example 14.7

Find a parametrisation of the curve given by  $y = \underline{x^3}$  between  $(0, 0)$  and  $(2, 8)$ . Calculate  $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$  for

$$\mathbf{F} = (2xy^3 - 3x^2)\mathbf{i} + (3x^2y^2 + 2)\mathbf{j}.$$



$$\tilde{c}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} t \\ t^3 \end{pmatrix}, t \in [0, 2]$$

$$\tilde{c}'(t) = \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3t^2 \end{pmatrix}$$

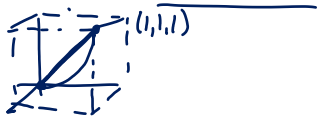
$$\tilde{F}(\tilde{c}(t)) = \begin{pmatrix} 2t \cdot t^3 - 3t^2 \\ 3t^2 \cdot t^6 + 2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2t^4 - 3t^2 \\ 3t^8 + 2 \end{pmatrix}$$

$$I = \int_C \tilde{F} \cdot d\tilde{s} = \int_0^2 \begin{pmatrix} 2t^4 - 3t^2 \\ 3t^8 + 2 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 3t^2 \end{pmatrix} dt = \int_0^2 (2t^4 - 3t^2 + 9t^{10} + 6t^2) dt = \dots = \underline{2056}$$

### Example 14.8

Let  $\mathbf{F}(x, y, z) = (y - x^2, z - y^2, x - z^2)$ , and let  $C$  be the curve from  $(0, 0, 0)$  to  $(1, 1, 1)$  parametrised by

$$\mathbf{c}(t) = (t, t^2, t^3), \quad 0 \leq t \leq 1.$$



a. Evaluate  $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$ ;

$$s = t^2 \quad s \quad s^2 \quad s^3$$

b. evaluate the same integral using a different parametrisation  $\mathbf{r}(t) = (t^2, t^4, t^6)$ ,  $0 \leq t \leq 1$  of the same curve;

c. evaluate the integral  $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$  along the straight line connecting the points  $(0, 0, 0)$  and  $(1, 1, 1)$ .

$$a. \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \int_0^1 \begin{pmatrix} t^2 - t^2 \\ t^3 - t^4 \\ t - t^6 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 2t \\ 3t^2 \end{pmatrix} dt = \int_0^1 (2t^4 - 2t^5 + 3t^3 - 3t^7) dt = \dots = \frac{29}{60}$$

$$b. \int_C \underline{F} \cdot d\underline{s} = \int_0^1 \begin{pmatrix} t^4 - t^6 \\ t^6 - t^3 \\ t^1 - t^{12} \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 2t \\ 4t^3 \\ 6t^5 \end{pmatrix} dt = \dots = \underline{\underline{\frac{29}{60}}}$$

$$c. \underline{c}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} t \\ t \\ t \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\int_C \underline{F} \cdot d\underline{s} = \int_0^1 \begin{pmatrix} t - t^2 \\ t - t^2 \\ t - t^2 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ 1 \end{pmatrix} dt = \dots = \underline{\underline{\frac{1}{2}}}$$





## A different piece of notation for vector line integrals

Using the notation

$$\mathbf{c}(t) = x(t)\mathbf{i} + y(t)\mathbf{j} + z(t)\mathbf{k} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{F} = F_1\mathbf{i} + F_2\mathbf{j} + F_3\mathbf{k},$$

we can write

$$\begin{aligned} \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} &= \int_a^b \mathbf{F}(\mathbf{c}(t)) \cdot \underline{\mathbf{c}'(t)} dt \\ &= \int_a^b \left[ F_1 \frac{dx}{dt} + F_2 \frac{dy}{dt} + F_3 \frac{dz}{dt} \right] dt \\ &= \int_C \underline{F_1 dx} + \underline{F_2 dy} + \underline{F_3 dz}. \end{aligned}$$

This is **alternative notation** for vector line integrals.

## Example 14.9

Evaluate

$$I = \int_C \underline{F} \cdot d\underline{s} = \int_C \underbrace{2ydx - 3dy}_{\text{Recognising the notation!}}, \quad \underline{F} = \begin{pmatrix} 2y \\ -3 \end{pmatrix}$$

where  $C$  is the curve parametrised by  $\underline{c}(t) = (t^2, t^3)$ ,  $0 \leq t \leq 2$ .

$$I = \int_0^2 \begin{pmatrix} 2t^3 \\ -3 \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} 2t \\ 3t^2 \end{pmatrix} dt = \int_0^2 4t^4 - 9t^2 dt = \dots = \left[ \frac{8}{5} \right]$$

## Properties of the vector line integral

Here  $C$  is a piecewise smooth oriented curve,  $\mathbf{F}$  and  $\mathbf{G}$  are vector fields.

- $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} + \int_C \mathbf{G} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \int_C (\mathbf{F} + \mathbf{G}) \cdot d\mathbf{s}$
- $\int_C k \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = k \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$  for constant  $k \in \mathbb{R}$
- $\int_{-C} \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = - \int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$ , where  $-C$  is  $C$  reversed.
- $\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \int_{C_1} \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} + \int_{C_2} \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$ , where  $C$  consists of two non-overlapping (oriented) segments  $C_1$  and  $C_2$ .



The curve  $C$  needs to be **oriented**: the sign of the integral changes if the curve is reversed.

## Theorem 14.10 (Fundamental for conservative vector fields)

If  $\mathbf{F} = \nabla\phi$  on some open set  $D$ , then for every oriented curve  $C$  in  $D$  with an initial point  $\mathbf{p}$  and terminal point  $\mathbf{q}$

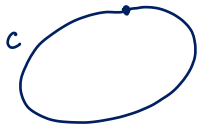
$$\begin{aligned}\underline{c}: [a, b] &\rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n \\ \underline{c}(a) &= \underline{p} \\ \underline{c}(b) &= \underline{q}\end{aligned}$$


$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \phi(\mathbf{q}) - \phi(\mathbf{p}).$$

$$\int_a^b \underbrace{\mathbf{F}(\underline{c}(t))}_{\nabla\varphi(\underline{c}(t))} \cdot \underline{c}'(t) dt = \int_a^b \underbrace{\nabla\varphi(\underline{c}(t)) \cdot \underline{c}'(t)}_{(\varphi(\underline{c}(t)))'_t} dt$$

$$= \underbrace{\varphi(\underline{c}(b))}_{\underline{q}} - \underbrace{\varphi(\underline{c}(a))}_{\underline{p}}$$

If the curve  $C$  is closed, then



$$\int_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \oint_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = 0.$$

the curve  $C$  is closed

path independent everywhere  $\Leftrightarrow$  integral vanishes on loops everywhere  $\Leftrightarrow$   $\mathbf{F} = \nabla\phi$

A physical interpretation of this result is that the work done by a conservative force on an object that moves between two points in space does not depend on the path.

### Example 14.11

Let  $\phi = xy + xz^2$  and let  $\mathbf{F} = \nabla\phi$ , that is,  $\mathbf{F}$  is conservative with potential  $\phi$ .

- a. Integrate  $\mathbf{F}$  along the curve  $C_1$ :  $\mathbf{c}_1(t) = \cos t \mathbf{i} + \sin t \mathbf{j} + \frac{2t}{\pi} \mathbf{k}$  from  $(1, 0, 0)$  to  $(0, 1, 1)$ .
- b. Integrate  $\mathbf{F}$  along the curve  $C_2$ :  $\mathbf{c}_2(t) = (1-t)\mathbf{i} + t\mathbf{j} + t\mathbf{k}$  from  $(1, 0, 0)$  to  $(0, 1, 1)$ .

$$a. \quad \int_0^1 \mathbf{F}(\underline{c}(t)) \cdot \underline{c}'(t) dt = \phi(\underbrace{\underline{c}(b)}_{(0,1,1)}) - \phi(\underbrace{\underline{c}(a)}_{(1,0,0)}) = 0 - 0 = \underline{0}$$

$$b. \quad \text{The same!} \quad \int_0^1 \mathbf{F} \cdot d\underline{c} = \phi(\underline{c}(b)) - \phi(\underline{c}(a)) = \underline{0}$$



### Example 14.12

Find the potential function for

$$\underline{F} = \nabla \varphi$$

$$\underline{F}(x, y, z) = \underline{(yz^2 + 1)\mathbf{i} + (xz^2 - ze^y)\mathbf{j} + (2xyz - e^y)\mathbf{k}},$$

$\begin{matrix} q \\ (3, 1, 1) \\ p \\ (1, 0, 2) \end{matrix}$

and hence calculate the work done by a force  $\underline{F}$  on an object as it moves from  $(1, 0, 2)$  to  $(3, 1, 1)$ .

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial x} = \underline{yz^2 + 1}$$

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial y} = xz^2 - ze^y$$

$$\frac{\partial \varphi}{\partial z} = 2xyz - e^y$$

$$\varphi(x, y, z) = xyz^2 + x + f_1(y, z)$$

$$\varphi(x, y, z) = xyz^2 - ze^y + f_2(x, y)$$

$$\varphi(x, y, z) = xyz^2 - ze^y + f_2(x, y)$$

$$\underline{F} = \nabla \varphi,$$

$$\varphi = xyz^2 - ze^y + x$$

$$\int_c \underline{F} \cdot d\underline{s} = \varphi(q) - \varphi(p)$$

$$= (3 \cdot 1 \cdot 1 - e + 3) - (0 - 2 \cdot 1 + 1)$$

$$= 6 - e + 2 - 1 = \underline{7 - e}$$

# Theorem 14.13 (Green)



Let  $C$  be a positively oriented piecewise smooth simple closed curve in a plane, let  $\Omega$  be the bounded region enclosed by  $C$ , and let  $\mathbf{F} = F_1\mathbf{i} + F_2\mathbf{j}$  be a vector field. If  $F_1, F_2, \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x}$  and  $\frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y}$  are defined and continuous in an open region containing  $\Omega$ , then



$$\oint_C F_1 dx + F_2 dy = \iint_{\Omega} \left( \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} \right) dA.$$

$$\mathbf{F} = (F_1, F_2) = (F_1, 0) + (0, F_2)$$

$$\oint_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \underbrace{\oint_C (F_1, 0) \cdot d\mathbf{s}}_I + \oint_C (0, F_2) \cdot d\mathbf{s}_J$$

$$\iint_{\Omega} \left( \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} \right) dA = \iint_{\Omega} \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} dA - \iint_{\Omega} \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} dA$$

To show:  
 $I = J$

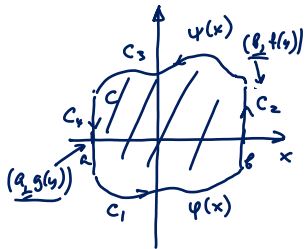
(similarly the other two integrals can be shown to be equal)



$$\begin{aligned}
 I &= \oint_C (F_2, 0) \cdot d\underline{s} = \int_a^b \underbrace{(F_1(x, \psi(x)), 0)}_{\underline{F}(\xi)} \cdot \underbrace{(1, \psi'(x))}_{\xi'(x)} dx \\
 &= \int_a^b F_1(x, \psi(x)) dx + \int_{C_2} (F_1, 0) \cdot (0, *) dy = 0 \\
 &\quad + \int_{C_4} (F_1, 0) \cdot (0, *) dy = 0 \\
 &= \int_a^b F_1(x, \psi(x)) - F_1(x, \varphi(x)) dx
 \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
 J &= - \iint_{\Omega} \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} dx dy = - \int_a^b \int_{\varphi(x)}^{\psi(x)} \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} dy dx \stackrel{\text{FTC}}{=} \int_a^b -F_1(x, \psi(x)) + F_1(x, \varphi(x)) dx \\
 &\quad \Rightarrow J = I ! \quad \square
 \end{aligned}$$

$C_1: (x, \varphi(x)) = \xi(x)$



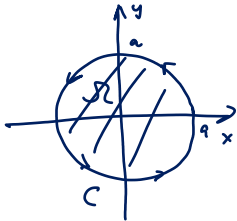
Only considering  
this special  
case!

### Example 14.14

Let  $\mathbf{F} = -x^2y\mathbf{i} + xy^2\mathbf{j}$  and let the region  $\Omega$  be given by  $x^2 + y^2 \leq a^2$ . Evaluate the line integral of  $\mathbf{F}$  along the boundary of  $\Omega$ .

Using Green's theorem:

$$\oint_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \iint_{\Omega} \left( \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} \right) dA = \iint_{\Omega} \frac{y^2 + x^2}{r^2} dA \quad \text{①}$$



$$\mathbf{F} = \begin{pmatrix} -x^2y \\ xy^2 \end{pmatrix} \Rightarrow \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} = y^2 + x^2$$

$$\text{②} \quad \int_0^{2\pi} d\theta \int_0^a \underbrace{r^2 \cdot r}_{r^3} dr = 2\pi \cdot \frac{1}{4} a^4 = \frac{\pi a^4}{2}$$

### Example 14.15

Compute the line integral

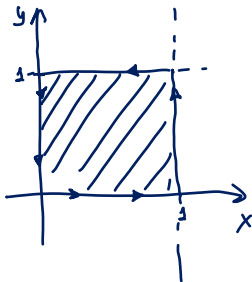
$$I = \oint_C (xy \, dy - y^2 \, dx) = \oint_C \vec{F} \cdot d\vec{s}$$

$F_2 \, dy + F_1 \, dx$

where the curve  $C$  is the boundary of the square cut out by the lines  $x = 1$ ,  $y = 1$  and the first quadrant, with anticlockwise orientation.

$$\vec{F} = \begin{pmatrix} -y^2 \\ xy \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Green's} \\ \downarrow \\ I &= \iint_0^1 \int_0^1 (y + 2y) \, dx \, dy = 3 \int_0^1 y \, dy \\ &= 3 \cdot \frac{1}{2} = \frac{3}{2} \end{aligned}$$



If we choose  $\mathbf{F} = (F_1, F_2)$  in such a way that  $\frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} = 1$ , then

$$\oint_C \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{r} = \iint_{\Omega} \underbrace{\left( \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} \right)}_1 dA = \text{area}(\Omega).$$

For instance, we can let  $\frac{\partial F_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial y} = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} = 1$

$$\mathbf{F} = -\frac{1}{2}y\mathbf{i} + \frac{1}{2}x\mathbf{j}, \quad \mathbf{F} = x\mathbf{j}, \quad \mathbf{F} = -y\mathbf{i}.$$

Then

$$\frac{1}{2} \oint_C -ydx + xdy = \oint_C xdy = - \oint_C ydx = \text{area}(\Omega).$$

## Example 14.16

Calculate the area bounded by the astroid

$$(x^2)^{1/3} + (y^2)^{1/3} = a^{2/3}, \quad a > 0,$$

using Green's theorem.

$$I = \oint_C \underline{F} \cdot d\underline{s} = \iint_R 1 \, dx \, dy = \text{Area}(R)$$

*because of the choice of  $\underline{F}$*

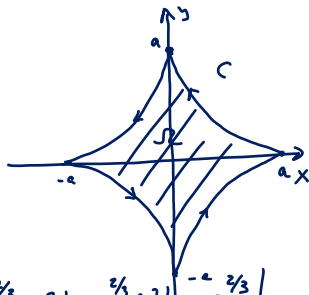
choose  $\underline{F} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ x \end{pmatrix}$

$$I = \int_0^{2\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ a \cos^3 t \end{pmatrix} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} \underline{c}'_1(t) \\ 3a \sin^2 t \cos t \end{pmatrix} dt = \int_0^{2\pi} 3a^2 \sin^2 t \cos^4 t \, dt = \frac{3\pi a^2}{8}$$

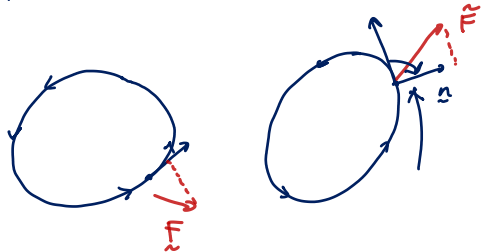
$$\underline{c}(t) = \begin{pmatrix} a \cos^3 t \\ a \sin^3 t \end{pmatrix}$$

substitute:

$$(x^2)^{1/3} + (y^2)^{1/3} = a^{2/3} \cos^2 t + a^{2/3} \sin^2 t = a^{2/3}$$



# Flux of a vector field



Flux integral:

$$\oint_C \underbrace{\vec{F}} \cdot \underbrace{\hat{n}} ds = \int_a^b \underbrace{\vec{F} \cdot \hat{n}} \cdot \underbrace{\|\vec{c}'(t)\|} dt \quad \textcircled{=}$$

$$\hat{n} = \frac{\begin{pmatrix} c_2'(t) \\ -c_1'(t) \end{pmatrix}}{\|\vec{c}'(t)\|}$$

$$\textcircled{=} \int_a^b \vec{F} \cdot \begin{pmatrix} c_2'(t) \\ -c_1'(t) \end{pmatrix} dt$$

$$= \int_a^b (F_1 \cdot c_2'(t) - F_2 \cdot c_1'(t)) dt$$

$$G := (-F_2, F_1)$$

$$= \int_a^b G_2 \cdot c_2'(t) + G_1 \cdot c_1'(t) dt = \oint_C \vec{G} \cdot d\vec{s} = I$$

continued

$$I = \underbrace{\iint_{\Omega} \left( \frac{\partial G_2}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial G_1}{\partial y} \right) dx dy}_{\text{Green's thm}} = \iint_{\Omega} \underbrace{\left( \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial y} \right)}_{\text{div } \vec{F}} dx dy$$

Green's theorem in normal form  
(under the same assumptions as thm 13.14)

$$\oint_C \vec{F} \cdot \hat{n} ds = \iint_{\Omega} \text{div } \vec{F} dx dy$$

$$\operatorname{div} \underline{F} = \left[ \frac{\partial F_1}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial F_2}{\partial y} \right] (*)$$

Define divergence;

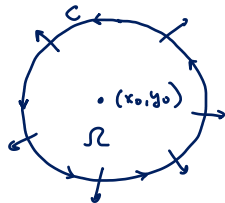
$$\operatorname{div} \underline{F} \stackrel{**}{=} \lim_{\operatorname{diam}(\Omega) \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{\operatorname{Vol}(\Omega)} \oint_C \underline{F} \cdot \hat{n} \, ds$$

$$= \lim_{\operatorname{diam}(\Omega) \rightarrow 0} \frac{1}{\operatorname{Vol}(\Omega)} \iint_{\Omega} \underbrace{\operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x,y)}_{(*) \text{ old definition}} \, dx \, dy = \boxed{\operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x_0, y_0)}$$

Green's thm  
in normal form

$$\underline{\operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x_0, y_0) - \varepsilon} \leq \operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x,y) \leq \underline{\operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x_0, y_0) + \varepsilon}$$

$$\operatorname{div} \underline{F}(x,y) \text{ is continuous} \Rightarrow \forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta > 0 \text{ s.t. } \operatorname{diam}(x,y) \in \underline{B((x_0, y_0), \delta)} \\ \text{we have}$$



$$\underbrace{\frac{1}{A} \iint_{\Omega} \underbrace{\underbrace{\operatorname{div} F(x,y)}_{\approx L}}_{\varepsilon} dx dy}_{L(\Omega)} \leq \frac{1}{A} \iint_{\Omega} \underbrace{(\operatorname{div} F(x_0, y_0) + \varepsilon)}_L dx dy$$

$$= (\operatorname{div} F(x_0, y_0) + \varepsilon) \cdot \frac{1}{A} \iint_{\Omega} dx dy$$

$$= \underbrace{\operatorname{div} F(x_0, y_0)}_L + \varepsilon \quad L - \varepsilon \leq L(\Omega) \leq L + \varepsilon$$

To show that  $\lim_{\operatorname{diam}(\Omega) \rightarrow 0} L(\Omega) = L$

we demonstrate that  $\forall \varepsilon > 0 \exists \delta > 0$  s.t. for  $\Omega: \operatorname{diam}(\Omega) < \delta$   
then  $|L(\Omega) - L| < \varepsilon$



